

Shourya Sen

CONTACT	Princeton University Department of Politics 001 Fisher Hall, Princeton, NJ 08544-1012, USA	+1 646 645 9975 shouryas@princeton.edu
EDUCATION	Princeton University , Princeton, NJ Ph.D., Political Science, (expected 2026) M.A., Political Science (2022, incidental degree) Exam Fields: Comparative Politics, Formal Theory & Quantitative Methods Other areas of focus: Political economy, Southeast Asia Committee: Carles Boix (chair), Leonard Wantchekon, Rory Truex, Germán Gieczewski Wesleyan University , Middletown, CT B.A. (with honors), Economics (2015) <i>Phi Beta Kappa</i> Honors Society (2015) University of Oxford, Lady Margaret Hall , Oxford, UK Visiting Student, Philosophy, Politics, and Economics (PPE)	2020-2026 2011-2015 2013-2014
AGENDA	I study how authoritarian regimes emerge, persist, and both shape and respond to their societies, with a focus on the legacies of conflict and the long-run political foundations of inequality.	
BOOK PROJECT	Action and Inheritance: Mobilizational Paths to Revolutionary Transformation. <i>In progress.</i>	
WORKING PAPERS	The Pull of the Center: The Mobilizational Roots of Transformation in Social Revolution. 2025. <i>Revise & Resubmit at World Politics.</i> Ties that Rebind: Kinship Networks and Long-Run Postwar Integration. 2026. The Democratic Externalities of Programmatic Electoral Victory: Evidence from Thailand, with Napon Jatusripitak. 2026. Economic Shocks, Sovereign Debt, and Authoritarian Institutions in the Third Wave. 2025.	
ARTICLES	Education for Control and Liberation in Africa and Among the Black Diaspora, with Guilherme Lambais, Dozie Okoye, and Leonard Wantchekon. 2023. <i>Comparative Education Review</i> , 67 (4): 861-883. Fishing Rights and Colonial Government: Institutional Development in the Bengal Presidency, with Richard Adelstein. 2021. <i>Cambridge Journal of Economics</i> (45): 313-331.	
BOOK CHAPTERS	The Art of Conquering Without Being Right: Agency, Education, and Learning by Doing in Cheikh Hamidou Kane's <i>Ambiguous Adventure</i> , with Paul-Aarons Ngomo and Leonard Wantchekon. 2025. In <i>Economics and Literature</i> eds. François Bourguignon, Avinash K. Dixit, Luc Leruth, and Jean-Philippe Platteau. London: Routledge.	

WORK IN PROGRESS	Who Stays in Opposition? with Somchai Phatharathananunth. 2026.	
	Anti-colonial Conflict and National Identity Formation in Southeast Asia, with Carles Boix. 2026.	
	Colonial Military Recruitment and Nationalist Mobilization: Evidence from Algeria and the Raj, with Hani Abdel-Warith. 2026.	
	The Political Losers Problem and Economic Transition in Resilient Autocracies, with Yuhan Zheng. 2025.	
	Three Networks in a Zomian Revolution (qualitative companion to “The Pull of the Center”). 2025.	
AWARDS AND HONORS	Harold W. Dodds Honorific Fellowship, Princeton University	2025-2026
	• Competitive fellowship that “recognizes exceptional students in their later years of study” across Princeton University	
	Best paper by junior scholar, APSA Southeast Asia Related Group (SEAPRG)	2025
	Southeast Asia Research Group (SEAREG), Fellow	Winter 2024
RESEARCH GRANTS	The Institute for Humane Studies	2026
	Data Driven Social Science (DDSS), Princeton University	2025-2026
	The Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice, Princeton University, for pre-dissertation and dissertation fieldwork	2022-2024
	Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies, for pre-dissertation and dissertation fieldwork	2022-2025
	Davenport Grant, Wesleyan University, for undergraduate thesis fieldwork	2013
PRESENTATIONS	MPSA	2026
	APSA	2024, 2025, 2026 (scheduled)
	Singapore Management University	2026
	Southeast Asia Research Group (SEAREG), Boston University	2024
	Harvard-Yale Southeast Asia Graduate Conference, Harvard University	2024
	Princeton University, Comparative Politics Seminar	2022-2025
TEACHING	Intro to Quantitative Social Science (undergraduate), Assistant Instructor	Fall 2024
	Comparative Politics (undergraduate), Assistant Instructor	Spring 2023
	Junior Independent Plenary (undergraduate), Assistant Instructor	Fall 2022
	American Center @ That Dam, Vientiane, Laos, Full-time Instructor	2017-2019
	Wesleyan University Writing Center, Writing Tutor	2012-2013
RESEARCH FIELDWORK	Created new survey infrastructure. Original data collection through community partnerships: surveys, genealogies, and oral histories.	
	Laos, Vientiane and rural areas in northern Laos	2022-2026 (total 8 months)
	Thailand, Bangkok and Isan	2022-2026 (total 8 months)
	Vietnam, Hanoi	2022 (3 weeks)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Office of American Spaces, US Department of State , Hanoi, Vietnam 2019-2020 <i>Consultant, Impact Assessment and Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E)</i> Designed and implemented surveys, conducted 40+ interviews and multiple focus groups, created impact evaluation and M&E framework for US embassy educational and civic programming in Laos and Vietnam. Conducted first ever impact analysis of American Spaces.
	Fulbright Program , Vientiane, Laos 2017-2019 <i>Fulbright Fellow</i> Developed syllabi for classes in English, social studies, and professional skills for university students and young professionals and taught full time at the American Center, Vientiane. Helped plan orientation and structure Fulbright program in Laos.
	The Northstar Group, Inc. , New York, NY 2015-2017 <i>Investment Associate</i> Researched investments and helped make portfolio allocation decisions at growing investment advisory. Developed and programmed Monte Carlo simulations to forecast portfolio performance.
LANGUAGES	Lao [fluent speaking & reading], Thai [intermediate speaking & reading], Bengali [fluent speaking, intermediate reading], Hindi [fluent speaking, intermediate reading], Spanish [intermediate speaking & reading], Khmu [beginner, no written script]
SOFTWARE	R, Stata, Python, MatLab, L ^A T _E X
REFERENCES	Carles Boix Robert Garrett Professor of Politics and Public Affairs Princeton University 406 Robertson Hall Princeton, NJ 08544 E-mail: cboix@princeton.edu Phone: +1 609 258 2139
	Leonard Wantchekon Professor of Politics and International Affairs Princeton University 321 Bendheim Hall Princeton, NJ 08544 E-mail: lwantche@princeton.edu Phone: +1 609 258 6723
	Rory Truex Associate Professor of Politics and International Affairs Princeton University 404 Robertson Hall Princeton, NJ 08544 E-mail: rtruex@princeton.edu Phone: +1 860 670 6297
	Germán Gieczewski Associate Professor of Politics Princeton University

311 Fisher Hall
Princeton, NJ 08544
E-mail: germang@princeton.edu
Phone: +1 609 258 9933

June 27, 2026